The Brute and The Beast

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Beauty and the Beast Elements, Alternate Universe - Beauty and the Beast Fusion, Gaston Adora, Beast Catra, Alternate Universe - Disney Fusion, himbo adora, Hunter Adora, Fluff, Pining, Mutual Pining, Love, Love Confessions, First Kiss, Magical Realism, Adora is a Flirt, Cocky Adora, Sweet, Tender - Freeform, Five Plus One, 5 + 1

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The Brute and The Beast

by ResFlower

Summary

"Oh."Adora's eyes widen and she can't help but stare. She's gorgeous, a woman with split eyes and a slender frame. The beast must have gotten her. Adora briefly wonders if rescuing her would jump start her ability to romance her . "I'm here to rescue you,"Adora announces proudly , leaning on one of the walls.

As she steps into the light Adora notices her ears are shaped like those of a cat and she has a tail. "I don't think you're here to rescue me."Her voice is almost angry as she takes a step closer.

"W ell, Iadmittedly didn't know there was a damsel in distress." Adora laughs, her hand reaching nervously behind her neck. The woman hisses and Adora freezes holding her hands up. "I'm not here to harm you, I'm just looking for the beast the villagers were talking about."

The woman rolls her eyes. "They were talking about me."She says flatly while twitching her ears pointedly.

OR
Five times Adora doesn't know exactly what she seeks at an abandoned castle and one time she finds what she's looking for. Gaston Adora xBeast Catra-Beauty and the Beast AU.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

One

"Adora!" She hears her name called out and she has to turn to catch the eyes of the woman who called it. "Oh, Adora!" She sighs and Adora smirks, making sure to flex as she and another woman get closer. Soon there are three pairs of eyes on Adora as if she's a tall glass of water.

"What can I do for you, ladies?" She asks gallantly , taking one of their hands and pressing a soft kiss to it. The woman looks like she might melt into the ground.

"There was a beast seen in the castle not far from here." A man interrupts Adora's shameless flirting. "Some folks here don't think you are brave enough to challenge it."

That makes Adora straighten up and turn to face him. "I have no issues protecting this village. The beast is as good as slayed now that I've decided to pursue it." She hears a symphony of sighs. The women are still here. Adora flashes them a bright smile, taking care to make eye contact with each one. "I'll be thinking of how to celebrate upon my return." She says with a waggle of her eyebrows.

"Maybe we can have a night on the town." One of them suggests, her voice filling with excitement.

"That seems like a fine idea." She agrees, smiling down at the three women. "Well, I must prepare if I'm to earn the right of celebrating with you lovely ladies."

Predictably, they all swoon. It's almost too easy at this point since Adora has made her reputation as the best hunter in the region known well. "You'll have to tell us the frightening tale!" One of them giggles.

"Of course. I'll tell you all about my adventures." She boasts, letting the girls cling to her arm. She flashes another smile. "I'll see you

once I've made this beast my throw rug."

She hassles the man who interrupted her for instructions and it doesn't take her long to prepare for her mission. Adora has never run into something she's been unable to do~~sh~~e knows she'll be able to get this done in the afternoon, and that'll show him for challenging her.

It's a far-of f jaunt on her horse, but nothing Swift Wind can't handle. When she gets close to the castle, she ties him up giving him an apple as a treat before petting down his nose. "I'll be back, Swiftie. Get ready to haul something big into town."

She knocks on the door, only to find silence greeting her. She shrugs, using her strength to shove the door open. It crashes with a loud bang and she steps over the shards of wood with her boots to get inside. Surprisingly, the castle doesn't look particularly unkempt. She knows it's been abandoned for years so this isn't really what she envisioned. She carefully makes her way through, noting that everything was old but well taken care of~~th~~e floorboards looked like they'd been recently polished. They don't creak as she carefully walks through the hall, looking for the monster. The man had been vague so she's not sure what to expect.

There are all kinds of trinkets and things in the various rooms she peers through~~-ol~~d clocks and teapots, paintings and tablecloths. She almost knocks over a vase but manages to still it as she goes deeper into the castle. She suddenly sees movement at the end of the hallway and she goes toward it quickly, trying to stay quiet but mostly failing. When she rounds the corner she's met with an unexpected sight.

"Oh."Adora's eyes widen and she can't help but stare. She's gorgeous, a woman with split eyes and a slender frame. The beast must have gotten her. Adora briefly wonders if rescuing her would jump start her ability to romance her. "I'm here to rescue you,"Adora announces proudly, leaning on one of the walls.

As she steps into the light Adora notices her ears are shaped like those of a cat and she has a tail. "I don't think you're here to rescue me." Her voice is almost angry as she takes a step closer .

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The woman rolls her eyes. "They were talking about me." She says flatly while twitching her ears pointedly.

Adora tilts her head. "No, it couldn't be." The woman is clearly that, if a little different than most of the people Adora knows. "Y ou're more like a kitten if anything." She adds to herself.

The feline woman hisses again, this time it sounds more embarrassed than anything else. "I'm not a kitten! I'm a magicat." She divulges. "And I want you out of my castle."

"So, do you want to help me find the beast terrorizing the villagers?" Adora tries again. "Before I leave your castle?" This time, the woman grabs her arm and pulls her straight outside before slamming the door. It happens so quickly she can barely get her bearings. "I guess that's a no." Adora mumbles. She sighs and decides to head back for the day.

Two

It doesn't sit right with her , to leave her word out that she's going to do something and then not accomplish it. So the very next week, she trudges all the way back to the castle, determined to have a different outcome this time.

"Why are you back?" The beautiful woman groans, eyeing Adora balefully. It's an odd thing how her tail switches back and forth. Adora

has no idea what it means.

"I'm nothing if not persistent." She says with a cocky smile. Adora isn't afraid of waiting out her prey or taking her time to track it. If anything, talking with a beautiful woman is better than what she usually has to do to catch an unsuspecting predator.

She eyes Adora warily. "I'll say." She huffs.

"You sure you aren't hiding the beast from me? Looking to protect the thing? Or maybe you want to claim victory for yourself?" Adora isn't the best hunter in the village for nothing. She's more than well-equipped to handle any situation. It's obvious that this alluring woman has some type of angle or motivation that makes her uncooperative.

She scoffs. "No. I just want my privacy. This is trespassing you know?"

"This castle is abandoned." Adora points out. Everyone knows that.

"No! It's very much not, I live here." The woman huffs as she crosses her arms, tail weaving behind her.

Adora furrows her brow. "Why don't you live in the village? Is this really your castle?" She looks around. Adora can't imagine living somewhere so big, especially without people around.

She sighs. "As much my castle as it can be anyway. Now I'd appreciate it if you and your biceps walk yourselves back to the village and tell everyone to leave me alone."

Adora raises an eyebrow. "You like my biceps?" She grins as the woman's ears flick back and her cheeks redden.

"I just want peace."

She shrugs. "Well, my name is Adora. The fastest way to get me out of your hair is to tell me where the beast is so I can slay it." She

offers. Adora doesn't usually play the nuisance but she can, if it gets her what she wants.

"I don't know what I have to do to get you to believe me. The dunces you call villagers were probably talking about me. Catra." She says as she points to herself.

Adora shakes her head. "Doubtful." She smiles widely. "That's a pretty name for a pretty girl, you know."

"Do you know how to do anything besides flirt and be dense?" Catra asks as she shakes her head.

"I hunt." Adora offers. "I'm the best hunter for miles around."

"Ah yes, the hunting. How could I forget?" She mutters crossly. "Well, unless you want to get into a fight with me, there isn't much for you here."

"Maybe you can give me a tour of the castle? That'll assure me that you aren't hiding it." She suggests mildly.

The brunette stares at her, wild curls framing her face. "You mean to tell me, hunter, that I need to disturb my own privacy to get you to leave even though you have no right to be here?"

"Well...it would be the easiest way?" Adora hedges.

"Fine. Come here." She tugs on Adora's hand with her clawed one. "It'll take a minute, it's a big castle you know."

Adora doesn't quite mind.

Three

The next time she comes back, Catra looks more put out than genuinely angry. "I put a sign that said 'stay away' would that keep you out?" She asks idly. "I thought you weren't coming back."

Adora did say she'd stay away, yet her feet had her wandering back toward the brunette for reasons unknown to her. "Absolutely not," Adora admits cheerily. "I can't read." She plays it off, hoping to avoid further questions about why she's back.

"You're joking." Catra stares at her, ears springing up. "You seem well off. Did you just never bother to learn?"

Adora feels a little exposed by the question. She thinks of boasting about her accomplishment like she usually does when she wants to avoid answering, but she feels a pull, to be honest with this woman.

"I'm well off now, but I wasn't always. Hunting isn't conducive to reading anyway." Her mother had starved herself to feed her and her brother. She'd learned quickly that food and later money were the key to staying out of misery. Learning anything that didn't help with that seemed a waste.

"Come here, hunter." She follows Catra until they reach a room with plenty of books. More books than Adora has ever seen in her life. She grabs a book and sits, staring at Adora expectantly. "Well? Do you want to learn or not?" She asks gruffly.

She freezes for a moment looking at the magicat. Adora takes a tentative step forward and sits next to her. "Is it so easy?" She asks timidly. For once, Adora feels afraid.

She watches as Catra smiles at her, a true smile. Really, it feels like the first smile Adora has ever received. The warmth of it burrows into her chest. "No, Adora. But you can be patient."

She frowns at that but nods. Adora isn't known for patience. Yet, as she listens to the soft explanations, Catra pointing at letters and explaining the sounds of words, she can't help but feel that she'd like to stay in the library a little while longer.

Four

"You're a menace! You could have died in that snow!" Catra hasn't stopped scolding her since she made it into the Castle after putting Swift Wind in the barn and feeding him.

"Well, there isn't exactly an easy way to come out here." Adora's dropped all pretense at this point, visiting Catra because she wishes to, whatever beast she'd been sent to slay beyond forgotten.

"You could just not come." She points out.

The thought itself makes Adora queasy. "Oh Catra, wouldn't you miss me?" She teases.

"I'd miss you more if you were dead." She ushers Aora to the den which already has a roaring fire, oddly enough.

"I think you're forgetting how big and tough I am." Adora flexes her arms in a typical power pose. It hurts because she doesn't really have circulation in her fingers at the moment. The way Catra eyes her warms her as if she hadn't just waded through four feet of snow for at least half an hour.

"Can you even feel your toes?" She finally asks.

In truth, Adora can barely feel anything below her knee. "Not exactly." She hedges.

"Boots and pants off." Catra orders.

Adora bites her lip. From the moment she saw Catra she instantly wanted her, but now might be the worst moment for her to finally give into Adora's charms. "You know, I'm not one to leave a lady waiting but it might be better if I have full use of my legs."

Catra stares at her in a way that makes Adora think she isn't impressed. "So you can dry off. And not lose an appendage. Not for anything else." She says it slowly while eyeing Adora. "I can't believe I have to explain this." She mutters under her breath.

Adora supposes potential hypothermia isn't the best aphrodisiac. "Fine." She starts stripping down, her legs feel like they have needles on them as they slowly regain sensation. "Do you have anything for me to wear?" She asks as she looks up.

The magicat seems frozen, her cheeks red and her eyes are caught on Adora's thighs. Her tail thumps against a near wall and that makes her break out of her thoughts. "Uh. Yes. Clothes. Give me a minute." She puts her hands up to her cheeks and walks away.

Adora smirks, happy to get some kind of reaction from Catra. She shoves a pair of too-big pants at her when she comes back and Adora uses her belt to tighten them to the point that they don't fall off her frame.

"Can we sit? My legs are still a little wobbly." She admits openly. She'd rather die than tell anyone in the village something like that, but she knows she can be vulnerable with Catra.

"I am sorry I worried you." She admits in a whisper. "They said the storm was only going to get worse and I always come this time of the week. I didn't want you to think I wasn't coming."

She shakes her head gently. "I would have realized it was the weather, Adora," Catra assures.

Adora catches her gaze, risking reaching out and holding her hand. "I don't know, sometimes it feels as if you doubt me." She'd been steadfast, coming for months to visit Catra and spend time with her. Hell, Adora could read full books now from all of the time she spent in the castle with the brunette. Most of the time Catra was receptive, even hopeful for a visit. But sometimes she looked at Adora as if she'd thought she'd never willingly come back. "You know... you can visit me too. I can show you the village. There's a library ~~not~~ as nice as yours, of course ~~and~~ a bakery with sweets."

Her ears pin back and she looks away. "Magicats can't eat sweets." She mumbles.

"Oh. W ell, there's a cured meat shop Iknow you'll enjoy . Ido a lot of the hunting for them so you know it's a quality product."She brags.

"I don't think that's a good idea."She looks down but she doesn't let go of Adora's hand. That makes her feel encouraged.

"Why not?"She asks gently .

Catra keeps her eyes steadfast on the fire. "I don't go into town."

"I've noticed. Im asking you to change that."She says simply . Adora isn't in much of a position to ask things of Catra, but she can't help but want to.

"Adora, no."She says firmly .

"Can you at least tell me why?"

"Isn't it obvious? Look at me!"She points down at herself, tail wrapping around her calf in anxiety . "The villagers will toss me out, or worse. There's no point in trying."

Adora does look at her. She's gorgeous, even in the well-worn dresses that have seen too many days in the castle. "That's not true. There's nothing wrong with you."

"Y ou know Im dif ferent."She says tersely .

"Y ou're differences don't make you any less important."Adora throws back. "Isn't that what all the books say? That you have to look beyond appearances?"

"Books are fantasies, Adora. They aren't real."She whispers.

"I thought you said they were anchored in truth."She points out. "Y ou can't have it both ways."Frustration leaks into her voice.

"Forget about the books, Adora. Iknow those villagers and Im not welcome there. Can you just drop it?"Her voice escalates to an

almost yell.

Adora sighs, rubbing one of her legs to try to shake the feeling of pins and needles. "I'll drop it. For now ." She gives Catra a soft smile and wiggles her eyebrows. "But I am persistent."

Catra shakes her head softly. "I know , hunter." She says it fondly now instead of like a curse.

"I just want to show you where I live." She explains, wanting Catra to see her perspective.

Adora's quieter around town but she's still well respected and admired. Still known as someone that could protect and provide. Maybe, if Catra saw that others thought of her this way, she'd feel the same.

"Maybe someday ." Catra offers feebly. "I'll think about it."

Adora grins. "That's all I ask." She's in truly no rush. She loves spending time with Catra in the castle anyway.

Besides, Catra never dropped her hand, now running soft circles across the back of it. It makes Adora feel like she's gotten everything she's asked for and more.

Five

The fire is warm and it's nice even though the edges of spring are visible in the slowly melting snow. She has Catra in her arms and it feels like a minor miracle. She's nuzzled under Adora's chin reading a book and Adora is skimming it over her head.

Well, sometimes. Most of the time she's just enjoying the quiet and warmth, thinking about how perfect this all feels. Adora's never been one for being still but she's learned of its benefits with Catra. Now that she's mostly learned to read—save for needing some help

sounding out really long, unfamiliar words~~it's~~ as if she can travel and go on adventures without ever leaving a room.

Adora presses her head to Catra's neck, and she can feel soft vibrations thrumming there from her purr. She's content~~beyond~~ content, Adora realizes she's in love. In love with this woman who has shown her the world within the confines of this castle, who is as patient and kind as she is rough around the edges. She longs to never part from her, to live nestled in the crook of her neck reading over her shoulder until she turns gray.

"What if I..stayed here?" Adora whispers softly into her folded ear .

She turns her head, a cute furrow making its way onto her brow. "What?"

Adora runs a hand over her shoulder, pushing down the bristling fur there. "I come often enough. There's plenty of woods to hunt. What if I just stayed?" The idea grows in her chest as she thinks of it. She could go into the village and sell her kills but instead of waiting until the end of the week to come to see Catra, she could just be here.

Catra turns in her arms so she's facing Adora, still pressed close. "With me?" Her voice drips with disbelief.

"Where else would I rather be?" It's a silly question. Nowhere else, Adora knew. There is nowhere far from Catra that can be better than this.

Catra rolls her eyes. "With everyone else. Living a normal life, not confined to a castle that's falling apart."

"But you're not out there." She gives up for the moment on telling Catra to visit the village with her because she doesn't want to start a fight right now. She just wants Catra to say yes.

Her ears pin back and her tail unwraps from Adora's leg. "So? There are other people. Other *women*."

Adora holds back a snort. She hasn't looked twice at anyone else since she started coming regularly to the castle. "I know I'd like to be here," Adora says instead. It makes no difference to her what's out in the world if the most important part of it insists on being here.

Catra looks away out the window, the edges of the village just visible on the horizon. "Well I~~d~~on't. I don't want you here all the time." She says suddenly and it feels like a blow.

Adora takes a deep breath and loosens her arms, peering down at the brunette. "Do you want me to go?" She supposes that she never really asked Catra if her company was welcome~~s~~he'd assumed it. She's never been unwanted it and it feels like the floor falling from underneath her.

"No!" She says too loudly, leaning up and pressing a hand to Adora's cheek before quickly snatching it away. "Being here all the time~~th~~at would be too much. I like what we do now." She assures. "We can keep doing that?" Her eyes are hopeful as she looks up at Adora.

Meanwhile, Adora's heart breaks in her chest. She'd been too forward and it hasn't worked out the way she hoped. She thought—well, never mind her silly thoughts. She should keep to what seems to work between them, lest she lose Catra completely.

She bites her lip. "Yes, we can. Do you~~w~~ould you read to me?" Adora asks, needing a distraction.

"Of course." She picks up the book she'd been reading nestled in Adora's lap, picking up where she left off. Catra's rhythmic reading is easy to focus on, and her eyes are on the page, which means Adora is free to stare and pretend she hasn't met rejection for the first time.

And One

It takes so much convincing Adora isn't even sure how she manages it. But she picks Catra up on Swift Wind and brings her to town,

preening in her victory.

"The first thing I need to show you is the tavern," Adora says conspiratorially as they drop Swift Wind off at the stables. "That's where all my hunting trophies are."

Catra laughs and shakes her head. "You're insufferable." She informs Adora before slipping her hand into Adora's.

They've walked a few blocks closer to town before the yells start. "Beast!" One of the villagers points at Catra, a thick sausage finger in her face. Adora moves in front of her, glaring at the man who skitters back like a cockroach. He's joined by others and Adora stares in disbelief.

"Stop! What is wrong with you all?" Adora yells loud and the small crowd gathering actually stops and stares at her. "Catra is no beast. She has the kindest heart of any living soul and knows more about compassion and loyalty than everyone standing here." She glares at the men and women staring. "She's beautiful inside and out and if you have a problem with her you'll find yourself at the wrong end of my rifle."

She's not actually planning on shooting anyone but it can't hurt to send a message. Mobs can get violent quickly and she'd rather not fight her way out of one if that's what this is going to become.

Adora reaches her hand and takes Catra's clawed one pulling her along as quickly as possible. She diverts from their path quickly, instead taking Catra to her cottage. When they get to her door she lets Catra in, making sure no one has followed them.

"I'm so sorry Catra. I can't believe them! You were right they're so simple-minded. I can't believe I was ever like that." She huffs, anger still burning in her veins. It never occurred to her that the villagers would be so overtly awful to Catra. She feels guilt sit low in her stomach for ever doubting her.

"Did you mean that?"

Adora stops and really looks at Catra. Her ears are pinned back and her eyes are glassy, moving between Adora's own. She stands in front of the magicat, a nervous smile on her lips.

"What I said to the villagers? Of course, I meant it." Adora tries to think back to the words she'd said, unsure which part of it Catra could be confused about. "Is there something specific you're thinking of?"

"You really... think about me that way?" She says slowly. "You think I'm... well, all those things you said."

"Yes. Very much." She fills her lungs with air, the love throbbing in her chest painfully. "You're so special, Catra. Don't let anyone tell you any different." She mutters fiercely.

Her eyes remain glassy, her tail twitching lightly at her side. "No one has ever stood up for me like that before."

"That's a shame." Adora shakes her head. "And it's a shame it needs to happen at all."

"Would you want to come with me?" Catra blurts out, her words feeling heavy. It makes Adora's mind jump to one place.

Adora freezes. "Back to the castle?" She clarifies cautiously.

"Yes. For good."

Adora's heart is a lump in her throat. "Isn't that~~you~~ said you didn't want me to stay." She reminds Catra.

"I lied." Catra bites her lip, one of her fangs peeking out. "I didn't really believe you could look past~~her~~ her ears twitch "~~you~~ know. Me."

Adora takes a step closer, her hand coming up to cup Catra's cheek. "There's nothing to look past." If anything, Adora wants to look at her forever. She shakes her head. "You're beautiful and good, Catra. Someday they'll all see it."

"So you'll come with me?" She presses.

Adora nods a slow smile spreading across her face. "Of course. If you remember, I'm the one who proposed it in the first place."

Catra just stares at her, as if seeing Adora for the first time. She then presses up on her toes and her lips touch Adora's. Adora has kissed many women but she's never felt as weak-kneed by a kiss as she does just then. She wraps her arms around the brunette, and her shoulders release tension when she feels Catra hold her in return. Adora cups her cheek, kissing her the way she's been wanting to for close to a year now since she showed up at Catra's home.

Adora pulls back to whisper, "does this mean you want me too?" She's so used to getting what she wants that she worries she might read too far into this.

Catra kisses her again. When she pulls back her smile is radiant. "Yes. Of course."

Adora has known many joys in life but having Catra return her previously unrequited feelings is like being buoyed in a warm lake, the joy somehow surrounding her and lifting her up. She kisses her again, running a hand into her mane and tugging her close.

"You have no idea how long I've been wanting this," Adora whispers into her lips.

Catra is panting, her pupils blown wide as she looks at Adora. "Wait, Adora. There's something else."

Fear pulls at her heartstrings. "What else?" She prompts as she eyes Catra.

"The castle has magical furniture."She says quickly . "It's complicated but there was a curse and it led to a few things including furniture that talks and is sentient."Catra laughs nervously . "It's another reason why Ididn't accept when you asked to move in."

Adora shakes her head. "I don't care if your silverware dances on the table for fun, Catra."She takes a deep breath, pulling the woman close. "I love you."She whispers. "Whether you want to stay in the castle or see the world or find a way to uncurse your furniture, Idon't care. Ijust want to be by your side."

Catra puts a hand on her cheek and pulls her down so she can press her forehead to Adora's. "I love you too."She responds and Adora can hardly breathe. "I'd love for you to come and meet everyone. Officially, anyway. And maybe we can find a way to undo the curse together."

Adora closes her eyes and nods, still pressed close to her love. Together sounds perfect.

End Notes

Ihad such a good time writing this!It fell very far away from the source material but TBH Ienjoyed that about it lol

This is the first AU based on another piece of media that I finish!Which feels astonishing given all the one-shots Ihave based on movies that Im working on lol. Hopefully , work stops kicking my ass soon and Ill have more time to write.

Kudos and comments are the best!Y ou can find me on Twitter and Tumblr.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!